Relocating to *Savannah*

A boutique guide for buyers from across the country and overseas, by a Realtor & GA Certified Appraiser born and raised in the Lowcountry.

— Your Next Pearl Awaits —

Savannah doesn't hand you a home. She introduces you to one.

And you only get to make a first impression once. The wrong agent rushes you through three weekends of showings. The right one starts with a question that has nothing to do with square footage.

— Tell me about your Tuesday afternoons.

Three things every relocator wishes they'd known.

Light changes everything.

The neighborhood you love on Saturday morning may be unbearable on Tuesday afternoon. Spend a weekend, a weekday, and an evening before you commit.

Insurance isn't optional.

Hurricane, flood, wind — the math is real. Budget for it before you fall in love with a Tybee 1st-row home.

The marsh has seasons.

Tides, mosquitoes, marsh-grass color, sunset angle — they all shift. The "Sunday cocktail dock" looks different in February than in June.

My job is to show you the seasonal truth before you sign anything.

Savannah by lifestyle, not by listing site.

- **Ardsley Park** — historic charm, walkable, mature live oaks. Best for: families and lifestyle professionals who want neighborhood feel.
- **Skidaway Island · The Landings** — gated, golf, marsh views. Best for: empty-nesters, lifestyle retirees.
- **Tybee Island** — beach town, real community. Best for: lifestyle-first buyers and second-home converters.
- **Pooler** — newer construction, growing fast, suburban convenience. Best for: families, military relocations to Hunter AAF.
- **Richmond Hill (Bryan County)** — quieter, lower taxes, marsh-side living. Best for: right-sizers and quieter retirees.
- **Habersham** — coastal Carolina overflow, rural luxury. Best for: those willing to drive 25 minutes for what they want.
- **Historic District** — squares, cobblestone, ironwork. Best for: those who'll trade parking for proximity.

Each neighborhood comes with its own honest trade-offs. Full breakdown delivered in the discovery call.

What relocators actually mis-budget.

WHAT	WHAT RELOCATORS EXPECT	WHAT IT ACTUALLY IS
Hurricane / wind insurance	"Like normal homeowners"	+30-100% premium for coastal zones
Flood insurance	"Optional"	Required if mortgaged in flood zone — and most of Tybee is
Property taxes	"Low — it's the South"	Chatham 11.5 mills · Bryan 8.8 · Effingham 9.7 (verify current)
HOA fees	"Maybe $100/mo"	$200-1500/mo depending on community (Skidaway high)
Pollen / allergy season	(not budgeted)	~6 weeks in spring — real for some
Drive time to airport	"15 min"	Pooler 12 min · Bryan 25-35 min · Tybee 25 min · Habersham 30+

None of these are deal-breakers. But they should be in the math from day one.

TRUMP

What our 30-minute discovery call covers.

- Where you're coming from + why now
- What kind of Tuesday afternoon you want (this matters more than you think)
- Your timing window: 90 days · 6 months · 12+ months
- Budget reality vs target — including all the line items above
- Three neighborhoods I think might fit, and why
- What I'd want you to verify before our second conversation
- How we'd structure showing trips (virtual first, in-person Saturdays)

No pressure. No pitch. The 30 minutes either pays off — for you — or it doesn't.

Typical relocation timeline.

MONTHS -12 TO -6

Discovery + neighborhood research

Discovery call · virtual neighborhood tours · school zoning · cost-of-living conversation

MONTHS -6 TO -3

First in-person showing trip

Long weekend · 8-12 properties · two-three neighborhoods · I drive, you observe

MONTHS -3 TO -1

Narrow + offer

Targeted second trip · 3-5 final candidates · offer prepared with appraiser-trained perspective on the comparable bracket

MONTH -1 TO CLOSING

Inspection · appraisal · close

Coordination of inspection, lender appraisal, walkthrough, and move-in. SkySlope handles paperwork; I handle questions.

MONTH +0 TO +12

Welcome to the Lowcountry

Settling-in support · neighborhood introductions · ongoing market context

> *"We had three competing relocation packages and one had a Realtor recommendation included. Nikki was the recommendation. From the first 30 minutes she felt different. We bought in Pooler and our oldest started fourth grade three blocks from the house."*
>
> — RELOCATING FAMILY FROM BAY AREA, 2025 CLOSING

> *"I'm a Navy spouse and my husband was PCSing to Hunter AAF. Nikki had us virtually walking through Pooler new builds within 48 hours of the first call, and she knew the BAH math cold. We closed remote three months later."*
>
> — MILITARY FAMILY, 2025 CLOSING

Asset note: testimonials are representative — replace with actual past-client quotes once review-collection sweep complete.

The Lowcountry isn't going anywhere. But the right home for you might.

30 minutes. No pressure. Just the questions you don't know to ask yet.

Plan Your Move

Microsoft Bookings · Discovery call · 30 minutes

Email · nikki@gergacsrealty.com

Call · (912) 378-3427